

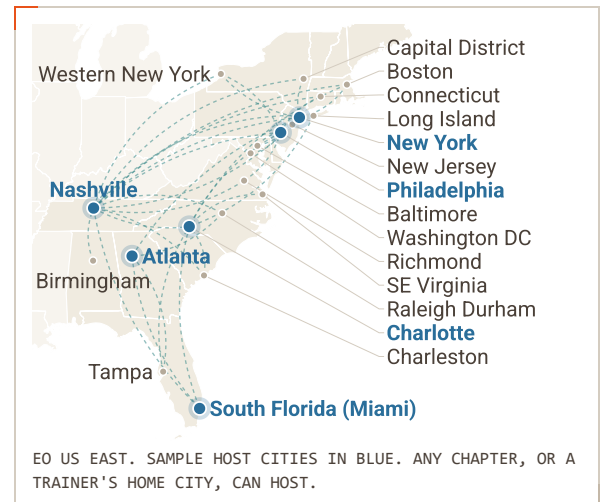
[A PILOT TO TEST]

REGIONAL TRAINING DAYS

An idea for any chapter to pick up and run with. Intake classes are shrinking, so instead of a thin small-group FTP, a virtual session, or a wait for a class of six, pool new members from several chapters into one full training day, hosted by a different city each quarter.

HOW IT RUNS

1. **Pick a host city.** Near the end of each quarter, one chapter hosts. Or fly members to a trainer's home city and the trainer's travel cost goes away.
2. **Dinner the night before.** The trainer joins when they can, so they know the room before they lead it.
3. **Make the locals the welcome committee.** Invite the host chapter's board, or the whole chapter, to the dinner. Gregarious members love meeting EO'ers from out of town, and they become ambassadors to the new class.
4. **Train all day, fly home that evening.** Wrap in time for late-afternoon flights.



WHY IT WORKS

FOR NEW MEMBERS

- ✓ Their chapter flew them out to their training, and they see how big EO really is.
- ✓ They make friends in other chapters who show up at regional events.
- ✓ Friday trainings turn into weekend trips.

FOR CHAPTERS

- ✓ A full training room. No \$250-per-person fees for empty seats.
- ✓ Trainer travel split several ways, or gone.
- ✓ Less fighting over preferred trainers' dates, and fewer trainers capped out before July 1.
- ✓ Better retention: forum members who visit outside their chapter renew at 95%.*

COSTS AND BUDGET

Venue. A local member's fancy restaurant, with the owner invited to dinner. It beats a hotel ballroom.

Flights. Each chapter books its own members' travel.

Dinner. The host chapter covers it, or each chapter chips in \$100 to \$200 per member it sends.

Trainer. Travel split across chapters, or zero when the training is in the trainer's home city.

RUN IT AS A PILOT

Test it this year. Ask the region for Forum, Membership, or Engagement funds to offset some of the costs.

*Prior data: a member who has visited an event outside their local chapter and is in forum has a 95% renewal rate.